

THE ROAD AHEAD

The makers of an independent India knew that they needed a clear roadmap in order to have a modern and efficient railway system. As a result, during the first decade after Independence, the Indian Railways focused on building self-sufficiency and development.



▲ **India's first air-conditioned suburban local train for Mumbai** was manufactured in Chennai's Integral Coach Factory (ICF) and introduced on 5 April 2016. These trains ply on the Harbour line of the Central Railway, have 12 coaches, and can carry 1,028 seated and 4,964 standing passengers.

Post-Independence, India embarked on a planned development programme for its economy with a series of Five-Year Plans, drawn by the Planning Commission, an institution set up by the Indian Government in March 1950. While the plans focused on socio-economic dimensions, the railways occupied an overwhelming portion as the policymakers recognized its crucial role in driving economic growth.